Microsoft Fabric cross-tenant access: Epic/Cogito as provider

Executive conclusion

Microsoft architecture: validated

Fabric supports a resource-tenant model in which provider-owned workspaces, items, data, and capacity are accessed by external Microsoft Entra B2B guest identities.

Epic/Cogito applicability: not yet validated

Available Epic-facing evidence does not establish that Cogito Cloud exposes a customer-accessible Entra resource tenant, Fabric capacity, Fabric workspace, or Fabric administration plane.

Architecture decision

Option B is technically valid only if Epic contractually and technically confirms the required Entra/Fabric provider capabilities. Otherwise, use a customer-owned Fabric platform that ingests data through an Epic-supported interface or export.

Bottom line: “Epic hosts Cogito” does **not** by itself mean “Epic operates a Microsoft Fabric provider tenant.” Microsoft Fabric is deployed into an Entra tenant; Fabric capacities reside in that tenant, and workspaces reside on capacities in the same Fabric organization. A guest accesses provider resources but does not transplant the provider’s workspace or capacity into the guest’s home tenant. [1] [2]

Microsoft’s primary Fabric B2B model is **guest access to the resource tenant**: the external user is represented there as a guest, navigates to that tenant through the tenant switcher or a direct URL, and receives access through workspace roles or item permissions. “External sharing in place,” where content appears in the user's home tenant, is a narrower model currently associated with Power BI semantic-model sharing—not the general model for all Fabric workloads. [3]

Available evidence establishes that Epic solutions can be deployed on Azure, but it does not establish an Epic-managed, customer-accessible Fabric tenant/workspace/capacity.(Source: HLS Solution IQ) Consequently:

- **Verified Microsoft pattern:** Epic could be the Fabric resource/provider tenant **if** it runs Fabric and permits customer B2B access.
- **Unverified Epic premise:** Publicly retrievable Epic material did not confirm those capabilities.
- **Recommended planning status: Conditional architecture—do not commit until Epic answers the confirmation questions below.**

The visual below summarizes the decision point. The provider tenant owns the Fabric resources; the consuming organization retains control of its home identities. This relationship follows the Fabric B2B/resource-tenant model and remains conditional for Epic. [3] [5]

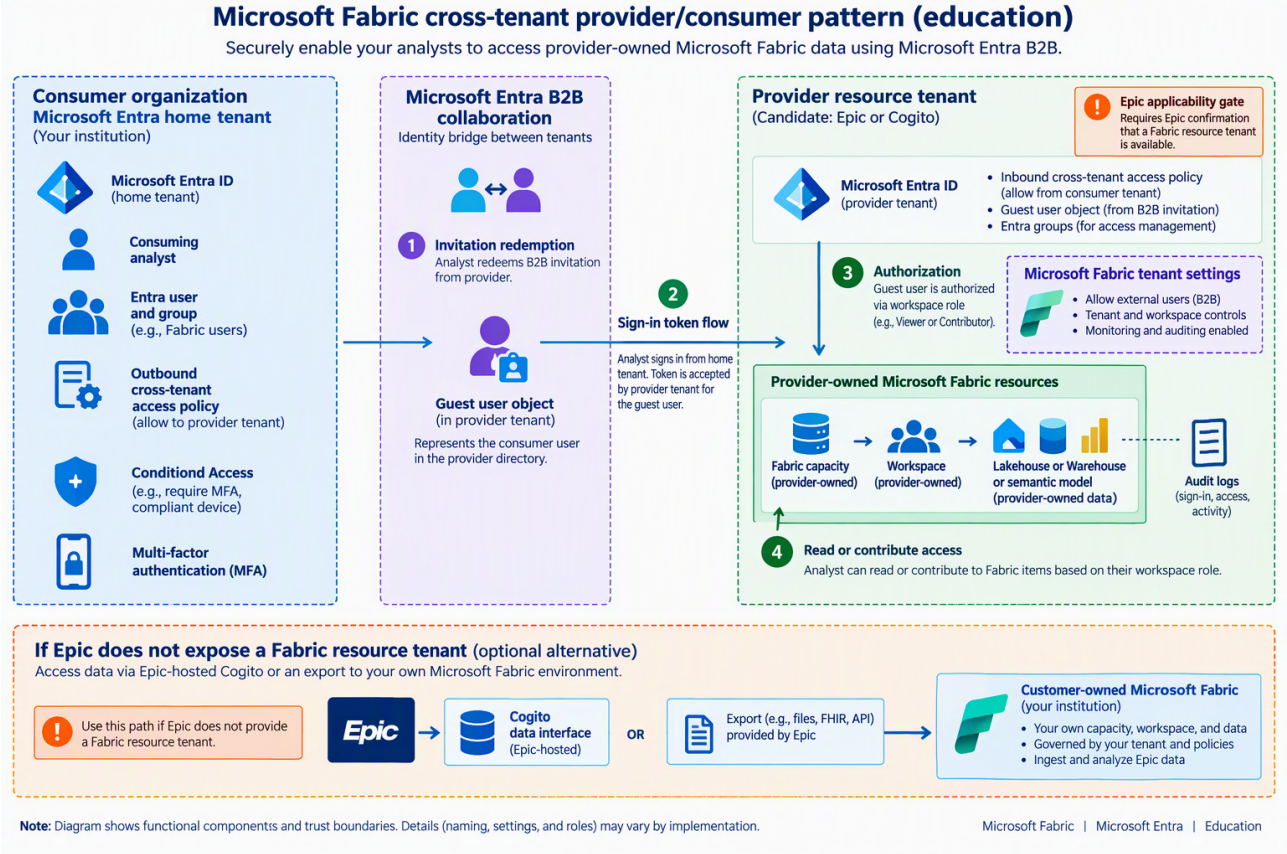


Figure 1: Cross-tenant Fabric access is a resource-tenant pattern: provider-owned capacity, workspace, and data are accessed by consumer home identities represented as B2B guests. Applying it to Epic/Cogito remains conditional on Epic exposing and supporting such a Fabric resource tenant.

1. Exact Microsoft architecture

Tenant terminology mapped to this scenario

Microsoft concept	Requested scenario	Ownership and responsibility
Home tenant	Your organization	Creates and manages employee identities, groups, MFA, devices, outbound cross-tenant policy and user lifecycle.
Resource/provider tenant	Epic/Cogito—**only if Epic confirms it exposes Fabric**	Hosts the Fabric tenant, capacity, workspace, items and data; issues or accepts the B2B invitation; controls inbound access and resource authorization.
Guest user	Your analyst/engineer represented in Epic's directory	Authenticates with the home organization's credentials but is authorized against resources in the provider tenant.
Fabric capacity	Epic-owned in direct Option B	Compute pool residing in the provider tenant; it is not "consumed from" or administered through your tenant. [6]

Microsoft concept	Requested scenario	Ownership and responsibility
Fabric workspace/ items	Epic-owned in direct Option B	Workspace is assigned to provider capacity; Lakehouse, Warehouse, semantic model, report and other supported items stay in the resource tenant. [2]
Cross-tenant access settings	Configured by both organizations	Your tenant controls outbound use of your identities; Epic controls inbound access to its resources and may trust MFA/device claims from your tenant. [5]

Supported identity model

The general Fabric model uses **Microsoft Entra B2B collaboration**, not a shared account and not a copied Epic identity. Invitation redemption creates a guest object in the resource tenant, while authentication continues through the user's home identity provider. [3]

For two legally separate organizations, ordinary B2B invitations, governed groups or entitlement-management access packages are preferable to assuming cross-tenant synchronization. Microsoft's cross-tenant-sync guidance says synchronization is intended for tenants within one organization and recommends entitlement management for invitations across organizations. [7]

Relevant Fabric tenant settings

The provider's Fabric administrator should validate these settings:

1. **Guest users can access Microsoft Fabric**

2. **Users can invite guest users to collaborate through item sharing and permissions**
3. **Guest users can browse and access Fabric content**
4. **Users can see guest users in lists of suggested people**

The first setting is fundamental. The remaining settings affect who can invite guests, discoverability and people-picker behavior; they need not all be broadly enabled if Epic uses an admin-controlled onboarding process. [3]

Workspace authorization uses **Admin, Member, Contributor or Viewer** roles. Viewer is read-only at workspace scope; groups can be assigned to roles to simplify access management. [8] Individual item sharing can be used for narrower access, but links for “people in your organization” do not work for guests; external sharing requires a guest already present in the resource directory. [9]

Licensing and capacity

Capacity remains provider-owned and bears provider workload consumption. Every Fabric user still needs an applicable user entitlement, and exact requirements depend on the item type, workspace license mode, whether the user authors or only consumes, and the capacity SKU hosting the content. [10]

Important operational constraints:

- A B2B guest cannot start a Fabric trial in the provider/resource tenant. [11]
- Provider-native administration should own the capacity. Internal Fabric setup guidance notes that B2B capacity administration and Fabric resource creation by invited external users are not supported paths. [12]
- Do not assume an F SKU removes all Power BI Pro/PPU needs. Validate licensing per workload and user action before production approval. [13]

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2. Epic/Cogito validation

What is documented

- Microsoft's healthcare catalog records **Epic on Azure** as a deployed solution, but the recorded claim is only "Epic deployed on Microsoft Azure." It does not claim Fabric tenancy, Fabric capacity, B2B workspace exposure or Cogito Cloud cross-tenant administration.(Source: HLS Solution IQ)
- Microsoft internal SQL guidance describes Epic analytics around **Clarity** and an Epic analytical data warehouse using SQL-oriented platforms; it does not establish that these databases are Fabric workspaces or that Epic supplies Fabric capacity. [14]
- Internal Fabric material contains a specific Epic signal for **cross-tenant Private Link**, but it also says the general tenant-level cross-tenant Private Link scenario is not publicly supported, can create DNS complications, and that Epic scenarios require direct product-team engagement. [15]

What remains unverified

No retrieved authoritative Epic source confirms that an Epic Cogito Cloud deployment:

1. supplies an Epic-owned Entra tenant ID to the customer;
2. provisions Microsoft Fabric in that tenant;
3. provides an Epic-owned F SKU or equivalent Fabric capacity;
4. exposes a Fabric workspace to customer B2B guests;
5. permits Epic administrators to configure Fabric tenant settings and workspace roles for customer identities;
6. supports customer access through `app.fabric.microsoft.com` in Epic's tenant;
7. supports customer Conditional Access/trust negotiation;
8. provides audit evidence and de-provisioning SLAs for those guest users.

Therefore, **"Epic/Cogito tenant" must be treated as a product-hosting boundary, not automatically as a Microsoft Entra or Fabric tenant.**

Questions Epic must answer

Request written confirmation of:

- Epic's **Entra tenant ID** and whether it is the Fabric resource tenant.
- Fabric capacity name/SKU/region and contractual owner.
- Workspace IDs and supported Fabric item types.
- Whether customer Entra B2B guests and customer security groups are supported.
- Who configures inbound cross-tenant policy, Fabric guest settings and workspace roles.
- Whether Epic accepts home-tenant MFA and compliant-device claims.
- Whether private access is public Fabric SaaS access, workspace-level Private Link, tenant-level Private Link, or an Epic-specific arrangement.
- Supported data entitlements: row/object-level controls, PHI scope, exports and downstream-use restrictions.
- Audit-log availability, access reviews, incident response and access-removal SLA.
- Licensing, capacity throttling, storage and egress charge allocation.

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3. Architecture Diagram A — trust and ownership

The direct pattern is valid only after the Epic confirmation gate succeeds.

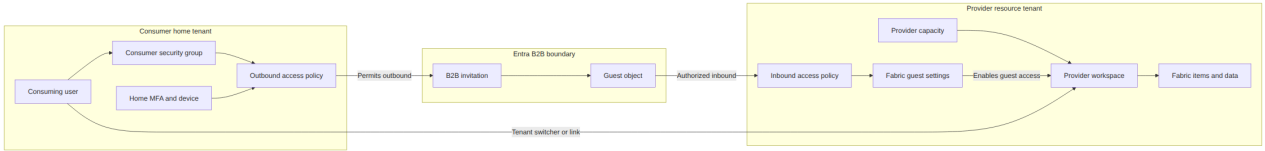


Figure 1: Flowchart

Administration direction: your organization administers the home identity and outbound policy; Epic administers the guest object, inbound policy, capacity, workspace, items and data permissions. The guest's workspace role does not confer ownership of Epic's capacity.

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4. Architecture Diagram B — configuration and authentication flow

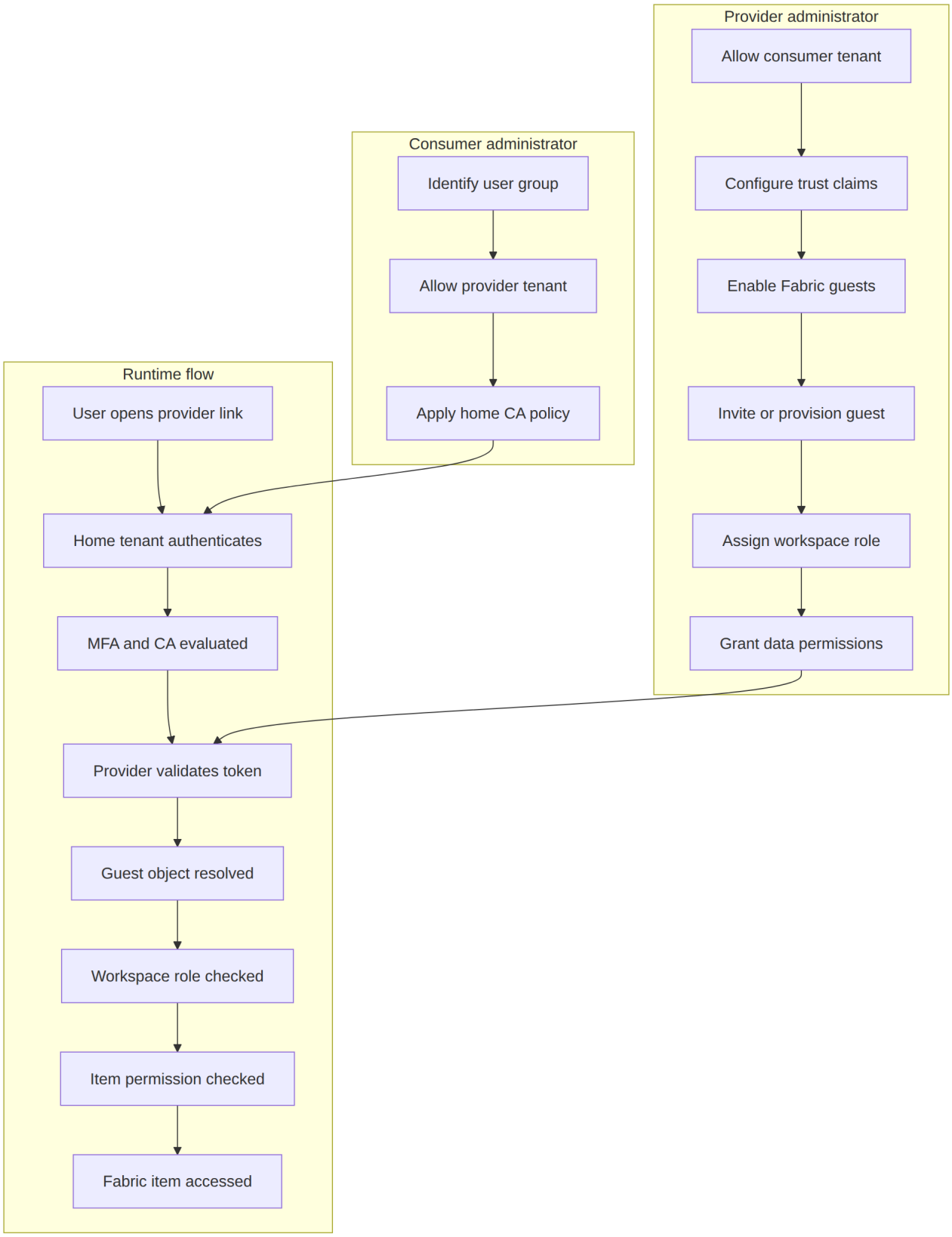


Figure 2: Flowchart

The resource tenant can apply Conditional Access to B2B users, require MFA, block selected external tenants or—if deliberately configured—trust MFA/device claims from the home tenant. [16] [5] Trusting a home MFA claim avoids duplicate MFA challenges; it does not delegate workspace authorization.

5. Architecture Diagram C — security boundaries and deployment sequence

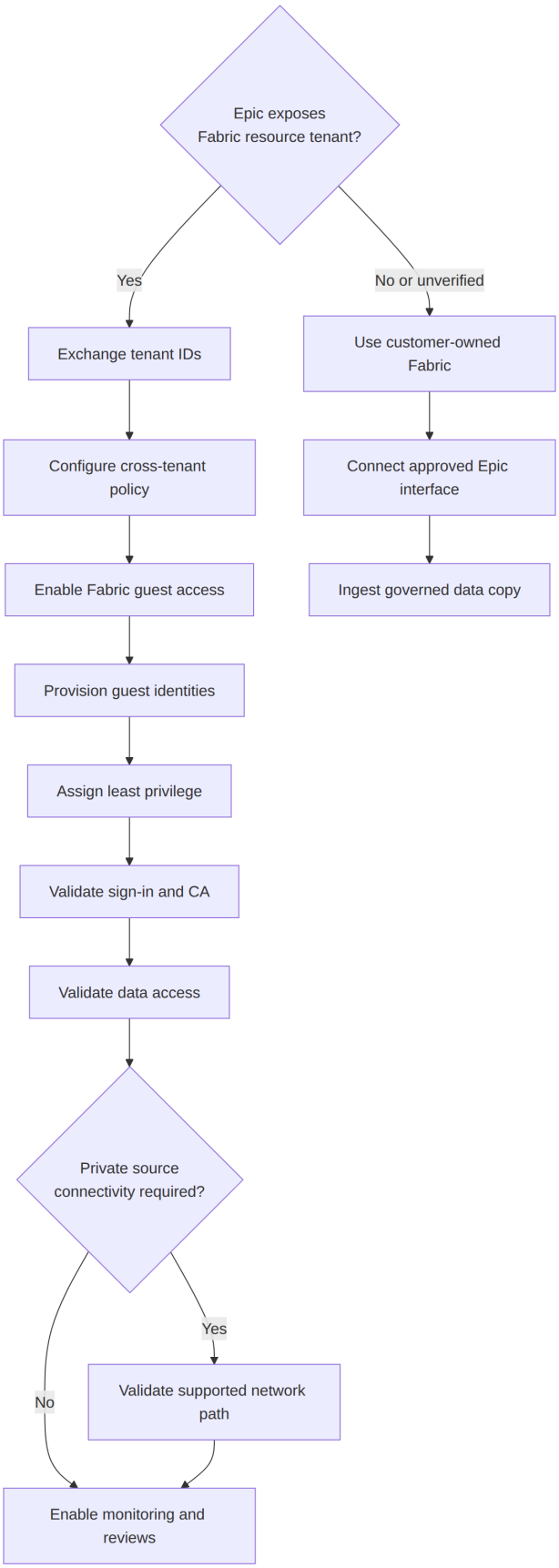


Figure 3: Flowchart

Security-boundary interpretation

- **Identity plane:** Entra B2B, inbound/outbound cross-tenant access settings, MFA/device trust, Conditional Access, guest lifecycle and workspace/item authorization.
- **Fabric data plane:** provider capacity executes workloads against provider workspaces and items.
- **Network plane:** B2B access alone does not create a VNet, gateway or Private Link. Add network controls only where a supported private data-source or Fabric-private-access design requires them.
- **Epic-specific private networking:** do not independently deploy cross-tenant tenant-level Private Link based solely on generic guidance. Internal Microsoft material flags this as an Epic/product-team engagement and identifies workspace-level Private Link as the general workaround for the unsupported tenant-level cross-tenant case. [15]

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6. Implementation checklist

Configuration	Owner	Control plane	Prerequisite	Expected result	Validation
Confirm Epic Fabric capability	Epic + consumer	Contract/ architecture review	Epic written response	Known tenant, capacity, workspace and support model	Collect tenant ID, workspace URL and architecture record
Exchange tenant IDs	Both	Entra admin center	Verified domains and security contacts	Correct partner objects	Confirm IDs independently

Configuration	Owner	Control plane	Prerequisite	Expected result	Validation
Consumer outbound access	Consumer	Entra cross-tenant access settings	User/ group scope	Users may access Epic tenant	Entra sign-in test
Provider inbound access	Epic	Entra cross-tenant access settings	Consumer tenant ID	Selected guests allowed	Provider sign-in logs
MFA/ device trust	Both	Entra cross-tenant trust + CA	Mutually agreed assurance	Expected challenge/ trust behavior	CA What-If and test identity
Fabric guest setting	Epic	Fabric Admin portal	Fabric administrator	Guests can enter Fabric	Guest opens provider URL
Guest provisioning	Epic	Entra B2B or entitlement management	Approved identities	Redeemed guest objects	Check external-user state
Workspace role	Epic	Fabric workspace access	Active guest/ group	Viewer or approved authoring role	Workspace visibility and role check

Configuration	Owner	Control plane	Prerequisite	Expected result	Validation
Item/data permissions	Epic	Fabric item/ security model	Defined data entitlement	Only approved data visible	Positive and negative tests
Capacity readiness	Epic	Azure/ Fabric capacity settings	Provider capacity active	Workspace runs on intended capacity	Confirm capacity and workspace assignment
Licensing validation	Both	M365/ Fabric administration	Named user actions/ item types	No license-related failures	Test consumption and authoring separately
Network validation	Epic + Microsoft PG if applicable	Fabric/ Azure networking	Documented private-access requirement	Supported routing and DNS	Connectivity, DNS and failure-path test
Governance lifecycle	Both	Entra, Fabric audit and access reviews	Owner and review cadence	Timely onboarding/removal	Quarterly review and termination test

7. Security, governance and operational considerations

Highest-priority controls

- Use consumer security groups and provider-side least-privilege workspace roles.
- Prefer **Viewer** plus narrowly scoped item/data permissions for consumers; avoid guest workspace Admin unless Epic has a documented operational need.
- Apply Conditional Access in the resource tenant and explicitly decide whether to trust home MFA/device claims.
- Maintain break-glass exclusions carefully, but do not exclude all guests from MFA merely to resolve a sign-in failure.
- Test both **allowed and denied** access paths, including deactivated users and removed group membership.
- Record where PHI is stored, processed, cached and audited; cross-tenant access does not change provider ownership or compliance responsibility.
- Separate Fabric audit responsibility from consumer Entra sign-in monitoring: effective incident investigation will require cooperation across both tenants.

Troubleshooting sequence

1. Confirm the user is in the correct tenant context.
2. Verify the guest object exists and invitation redemption is complete.
3. Inspect consumer outbound and Epic inbound cross-tenant policies.
4. Inspect both tenants' Entra sign-in logs and Conditional Access results.
5. Verify **Guest users can access Microsoft Fabric**.
6. Confirm workspace role, item permissions and underlying data permissions.
7. Confirm user license and provider capacity/workspace state.
8. Only then investigate private-network, DNS, gateway or data-source connectivity.

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8. Realistic fallback if Epic does not expose Fabric

The evidence-backed fallback is **not** to simulate cross-tenant Fabric access. Instead:

1. Run Fabric capacity, workspaces and governance in **your organization's tenant**.
2. Obtain data through an **Epic-supported, contractually approved interface**.
3. Ingest or reference that data using the Fabric connector, gateway, API or file-transfer mechanism appropriate to the interface Epic confirms.
4. Keep Entra identity, Fabric administration, capacity operations, Purview/governance and audit ownership in your tenant.

Candidate interfaces—SQL access to approved Clarity/Caboodle structures, scheduled extracts, managed file/object delivery, APIs or FHIR-based mechanisms—must be selected from the organization's Epic licensing and Epic's written support statement. The retrieved evidence supports Epic's SQL-oriented analytics architecture, but not any particular cloud-export method for this engagement. [14]

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9. Evidence-quality assessment

Classification	Assessment
Microsoft-documented behavior	High confidence: Entra B2B resource-tenant model, guest object, tenant switcher/direct-link access, Fabric guest settings, capacity/workspace ownership, workspace roles and cross-tenant policy behavior are consistently reflected in Microsoft Learn-linked technical material. [3] [5]
Epic-documented facts	Insufficient for Option B: retrieved evidence confirms Epic on Azure but not customer-accessible Epic Fabric tenancy or B2B workspace exposure. (Source: HLS Solution IQ)

Classification	Assessment
Microsoft internal Epic signal	Material but not customer-contract evidence: Epic is explicitly called out in internal cross-tenant Private Link guidance, with product-team engagement required. [15]
Recommended architecture	Direct B2B is conditional on Epic confirmation. Customer-owned Fabric with an Epic-supported data interface is the safer default until that confirmation exists.

Technical-review disposition: mark Option B as **“conditionally viable / Epic validation pending,” not “approved.”**